

Title	Version	Date
IBL Publication Policy	2.1	1st October 2026
Authors		
IBL Core		
Abstract		
The IBL Publication Policy outlines policies and procedures pertaining to the planning, creation, and dissemination of scientific communications involving the IBL Core and/or IBL data and resources.		

IBL Publication Policy

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Section 1: Goals & Scope

The goal of this policy is to ensure:

- a. Scientific communications that bear the IBL name meet the highest standards of accuracy and integrity;
- b. All IBL Core members whose work has made a material difference to a publication – through pipeline development, data processing, quality control, analysis, or writing – are recognised appropriately;
- c. Disputes over authorship are avoided, and if they arise they are dealt with fairly, rapidly, and to the satisfaction of all IBL network members.

The scope of this policy covers all public communications of scientific work for which any of the three criteria are met:

- a. uses IBL data and/or resources before their public release, or
- b. uses IBL data and/or resources after their public release *and* includes an IBL Core member, or
- c. claims to speak on behalf of the IBL Core.

Collaborators involved in IBL 1.0 projects should follow the [previous publication policy](#).

Section 2: Types of Communications

Papers

A paper is a long-form narrative of findings submitted to a peer-reviewed journal and/or online repository, and assigned a DOI number. Papers may include (but are not limited to) scientific results, data releases, perspectives or recommendations, technical, or logistical developments.

Conference papers

A conference paper is a long-form narrative of findings submitted for presentation at an academic conference or meeting, published in a proceedings, and which is typically deposited in an online repository and assigned a DOI number.

Abstracts



An abstract is a summary of findings submitted for presentation at an academic conference or meeting. Abstracts may include (but are not limited to) scientific results, data releases, perspectives or recommendations, technical, or logistical developments.

Posters and talks

A poster or talk is a formal presentation to a public audience. They may include (but are not limited to) scientific results, data releases, perspectives or recommendations, technical, or logistical developments. This policy covers those elements of presentations sharing unpublished IBL work. Internal presentations to a lab or private discussions are not included.

Theses

Masters and doctoral theses are written long-form scientific communications, not necessarily published, that are covered by *Section 1: Goals and Scope*.

Section 3: Authors

Authors are those who contribute to the communication.

Author types

All communications must include 'The International Brain Laboratory' as an author. Optionally, communications may also include IBL network members – the IBL Core, Project Partners, and Affiliates – and non-IBL members, such as outside collaborators or contractors. An exception is made for theses.

Author contributions

A contribution is defined as an effort that facilitates the content, preparation, design, execution, or delivery of a communication.

- a. Author contributions are listed in an appropriate place within a communication, with the consent of all authors.
- b. All author contributions will be tracked and maintained over the lifetime of the communication draft, and made easily accessible.

Author lists

Anyone who has participated in the generation of a paper (for example by performing any of the work listed in the [CRediT Taxonomy](#)) should be included as an author (this includes but is not limited to: IBL Core staff, IBL Core PIs, and external collaborators). Credit should be given for any contributions not currently described in another publication or for resources that were used prior to public release. A preliminary author list shall be generated and maintained by the first author.

Each listed individual must submit a contribution statement. Individuals not included in the preliminary author list can opt in by providing a contribution statement to the first author or task force. Any conflicts arising from the author lists or contribution statements will be mediated by the IBL Ombuds.

The final contributions statement will be collated and styled by the first author.

Author order

Authors will be ordered according to their degree of contributions, or any other scheme to which all authors agree. 'The International Brain Laboratory' may be listed as an author in any position, alongside any number of named individuals.

Section 4: Pre-Submission Notification

Collaborators must notify the IBL Core of any active publication at least 30 days before submission. Early notification – at the outline stage – is strongly preferred. Notification should be sent to the designated IBL Core project contact and to: info@internationalbrainlab.org. IBL Project Partners should send a notification to the network through the Slack announcements channel as well.

The notification should include:

- A working title and brief description of the manuscript.
- The proposed author list, including the basis for IBL Core authorship or acknowledgement.
- Confirmation of planned data and code release (repository, timeline).
- Any embargo or journal-specific constraints that may affect data sharing.



The IBL Core will review the notification and respond within 10 business days. If no response is received, collaborators may proceed with the proposed submission plan.

Section 5: Preprints

Posting of preprints is encouraged and consistent with IBL's open science values. The same notification, authorship, and data sharing standards apply to preprints as to peer-reviewed publications. Collaborators should notify IBL Core before posting.

Section 6: IBL-Initiated Publications

Where the IBL Core initiates a publication that incorporates data or analysis contributed by a collaborator (e.g., a benchmark or methods paper), the relevant project team members will be offered authorship or acknowledgement commensurate with their contribution, following the same principles above. The IBL Core will notify collaborators of planned publications involving their data as early as feasible and no later than 30 days before submission.

Section 7: IBL Software Packages

When using software packages developed by IBL Core, please cite the authors as *International Brain Laboratory*, followed by *{package name} contributors*, rather than listing individual contributors. Contributions to each package are publicly documented on GitHub.